The Bioinfo4Women International Pilot Mentoring Programme for Young Scientists

bioinfo 4women

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Mission and Vision

1. Promote recognition of achievements
2. Support women transition from senior postdocs to junior PIs
3. Raise awareness and promote research on sex and gender bias in science
4. Increase women participation and leadership by promoting exchange of knowledge
5. Establish networks of researchers and institutions

the **Bioinfo4Women** programme

PILOT OBJECTIVES

Long-term

1. Highlight successful **female role models.**
2. Encourage **proactivity** in Career Management.
3. Increase provision of **High-quality feedback** for professional development.
4. Increase **female leaders in front-line research** in Computational Biology.
5. Fostering a collaborative scientific community where **solidarity, gender equality and excellence** are the norm.

Short-term

1. To initiate a **pilot scheme** with a duration of 1 year
2. **Train** Mentors and Mentees.
3. Create **Mentoring relationships** outside the mentee's specific research field.
4. Maximize **Mentee's skills and potential** overall, to advance to more senior roles within STEM.
5. **Evaluate** the pilot programme.
6. Plan further editions, including **support for postdoctoral** researchers in their transition to independent researcher positions.

Internationalization and networking

- Promote an international collaboration **network** of women in computational biology.
- **Research seminars** at BSC (remote) including reflection of experiences of **women in science**.
- Participation/organization of **events**.
- **B4W Fellows** programme.

Support women's scientific career

Mentoring programme

- **Pilot** B4W Mentoring programme in 2022 - provide international **role models** to junior researchers.
- Build **international network** of Bioinfo4Women-related **mentors and mentees**.

Training plan

- Gender dimension in research incorporated into **PhD training** programme at BSC.
- Review BSC **soft skills** training courses from gender-sensitive standpoint.
- **Job description** writing from non-biased perspective.

Research line

Include the **sex** and **gender perspective** in the Life Sciences department research practice by:

- Developing **guidelines** for researchers, providing specific examples of how to implement it within each research group.
- Creating a **repository** (papers, datasets, etc.) with scientific evidence regarding this topic.

Strategy and sustainability

- **Strategic decisions** aligned with the BSC Life Sciences Dept and other European efforts.
- **Financial aspects** of the programme and sustainability strategy.
- Implement **actions** approved.

Communication

- **Dissemination** of events organised by B4W and those external of relevance, publications, and inspiring stories that foster changes in the gender and diversity imbalance in research.
- **Outreach** to the research community and beyond.

WHO IS THE PILOT FOR?

What are the benefits?

Mentors 8

Female leaders and allies strongly advocating for gender equality in science.

Develop relationship building skills

Increased creativity and fresh ideas

Networking with other institutions

Increased role profile

Mentees 8

Young scientists, with at least 70% women.

Access to wider professional network

Greater self awareness of skills and aptitude

Explore goals and Achievements with experienced scientists

Enhanced career opportunities

TIMELINE

For the Pilot programme

June 2022 → **Training** → **Matching algorithm** → **Mentor-Mentee pairs** → **Individual meetings** → **Wrap-up** → **June 2023**

For Mentors
Key competencies, interpersonal skills

For Mentees
Personal learning objectives

Matching algorithm
Mentees prioritise 4 Mentors

Individual meetings
Called by the Mentee

Follow-up sessions
For Mentors and Mentees

RESULTS

Evaluation of training received by Mentors and Mentees

0 — 5

- **Overall satisfaction** 4.46/5
- **Workshop content** 4.75/5
- **Meeting expectations** 4.33/5
- **Training applicable to near future** 4.67/5

Mentor quotes

> *I really love the course, very useful and clarify many points however I was expecting more exercises to improve "leadership" skills specific for science (i.e. How to deal with "PhD-Supervisor" relationship) but I guess this require a different course. So, I will love if you organize something in this direction. Thanks!*

> *I think what will really help is to establish a network of mentors that can keep in touch as we go along with the program*